Key points to remember for your interview

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Use this as a final check the day before your interview.

Before the interview

- Six or seven written stories, about 250 words each.
- A number in every Result. If a story has no number, find one or replace the story.
- A table mapping your stories to the nine categories, with no empty column.
- A story about a failure, and one about disagreeing with your manager. These are the two most often missing.
- A short, honest answer to why you are leaving your current job, under a minute.
- Three or four questions to ask at the end.
- Each story said out loud once, and timed.

During an answer

- Take two seconds to choose the story before you start talking.
- Give enough context to judge the difficulty, and no more. About 20 seconds.
- Say what you were responsible for. Most candidates skip this.
- Use "I" rather than "we" when describing what you did.
- Keep to about three actions. You can add more if they ask.
- Include one decision and the reason behind it.
- Finish with the result, and say the number.

Throughout

- Talk about work and behavior, never about a person's character.
- Be honest about what went wrong. Stories where everything worked are less convincing.
- Do not claim more credit than you had. A follow-up question will find it.
- If you go blank, say you are thinking of a good example. Nobody is marked down for a pause.
- Answer the question you were asked, not the one you prepared for.

Expect a follow-up on every answer

The follow-up is where this round is decided. Be ready for these four on any story:

- What would you have done if that had not worked?
- What did the other people involved think?
- What would you do differently now?
- Why that approach instead of the alternative?

Answer from the real details of your own project. That is the whole reason to use your own stories rather than anyone else's.

Mark as Completed

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Ask question at the end of the interview

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Ending note

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